THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why did Europeans seek new sea routes to India? 1

(a) They wanted to teach Indians
(b) Land routes were controlled by others and trade was profitable
(c) They had no ships
(d) They disliked trade

2. The drain of wealth theory claims that 1

(a) India became rich
(b) Britain invested all
(c) India's resources flowed to Britain without return
(d) taxes were low

3. Indigo planters were resented because 1

(a) paid high prices
(b) ended tax
(c) they forced peasants to grow indigo at low prices
(d) built schools

4. The cartaz system shows that the Portuguese 1

(a) tried to control Arabian Sea trade **(b)** avoided Asia
(c) encouraged free trade **(d)** had no navy

5. Cheap British cloth ruined Indian weavers because 1

(a) it was costlier to make
(b) weavers disliked work
(c) there was no demand
(d) Indian cloth was heavily taxed in Britain

6. The Goa Inquisition illustrates 1

(a) trade policy **(b)** tolerance
(c) free worship **(d)** religious intolerance of colonial rule

7. The Dutch failed to dominate India because 1

(a) they won all battles
(b) they had no trade
(c) they were defeated at Colachel and challenged by the British
(d) they ruled all India

8. Macaulay wanted English education to produce 1

(a) traders **(b)** scholars of Sanskrit
(c) a class loyal to British administration **(d)** tribal leaders

9. Which pair is correctly matched? 1

(a) Panipat - British **(b)** Haldighati - Dutch
(c) Plassey - Marathas **(d)** Colachel - Travancore

10. The French failed to dominate India mainly because 1

(a) they loved trade
(b) they had no ships
(c) they were checked by the British in the Carnatic Wars
(d) they were Indian

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why did Europeans want direct trade with India? 2

12. Why were railways built in India? 2

13. What did Indian leaders mean by 'drain'? 2

14. How did divide and rule help the British? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Explain how the Portuguese tried to control the Arabian Sea. 3

16. Explain the effect of tariffs on Indian crafts. 3

17. Explain how 1857 became a mass uprising. 3

OR

Compare Dutch and French fortunes in India. 3

18. Explain how education policy changed under Macaulay. 3

OR

Describe the role of Rani Lakshmibai in 1857. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Explain why Europeans came to India and why only the British succeeded. 5

OR

Examine early Indian resistance before 1857. 5

20. Analyse the methods by which the East India Company expanded its control. 5

OR

Evaluate the claim that railways were a gift of the British. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

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